

## Maintaining Consistency Within and Across Agiloft RFXs



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## Introduction

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Consistency makes it possible to find information quickly and better understand what you're reading. And, consistency is accomplished through a combination of branding, formatting, and writing style.

If there's one thing we can learn from marketing professionals, it's the power of consistency accomplished through branding. Branding increases confidence in the quality of the content and the intentional design of the information.

Formatting consistency is also vital. It simplifies navigating through the document so readers can get the information they need quickly and easily, as well as make more informed decisions. The document looks professional too!

Nothing is more frustrating for reviewers than reading through a proposal and continually getting stopped by writing style inconsistencies. Like branding and formatting inconsistencies, these simple mistakes—which can be easily fixed—detract from the message. More importantly, they make the reader question your reliability and authority on the subject matter.

## Consistency Counts

If you don't think consistency is important, think again. Here are two comments we received from prospective customers who received our RFXs.

Hi Donna,

I just thought I'd pass a little bit of feedback along from Patrick at Novo Nordisk. I reached out to him yesterday to make sure that everything made it through properly following some issues with the Ariba submission form.

Everything is in order over there, and Novo is going to be evaluating the RFPs over the next few weeks, but Patrick wanted me to pass along his compliments to whoever it was that was responsible for completing the RFP itself, as he said it was much more readable and comprehensive than the majority of RFPs he has evaluated...

From Jason Berman, Sales Engineer

Hi Donna,

I just got the call that we are a finalist on the [Compassion International] CI RFP. Chris spoke so highly of how much we stand out from the competition and how great our response was.

This was particularly important as they came to us from Gartner unofficially, so I just wanted to thank you for your support, and stellar (as always) work...

From Noe Ramos, SME Sales Representative

## Maintaining Consistency Within and Across Agiloft RFXs

### Agiloft RFX Templates

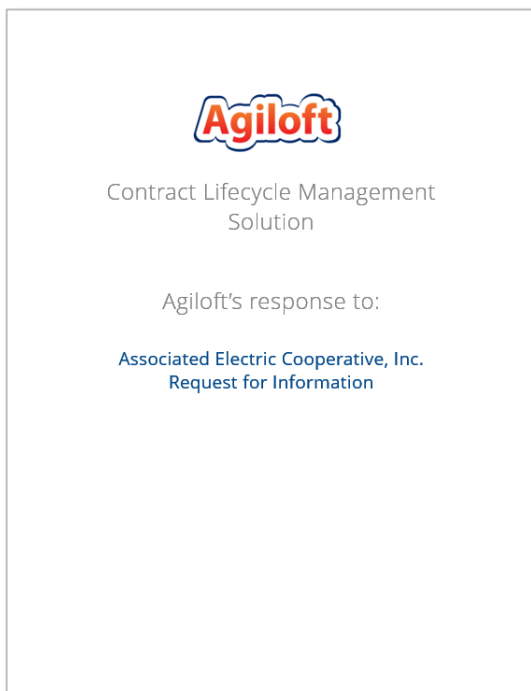
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The Agiloft RFX templates are pre-constructed Word documents created and designed to:

- 1) Speed up the preparation and development process.
- 2) Maintain consistency within and across RFX responses.

Nothing needs to be done with these templates as they have already been created to align with Agiloft's Brand Guidelines. The goal is to make sure that when you start a new RFX, you use one of these approved Agiloft templates (.dotx).

Also, verify you are using the correct template for the relevant opportunity type, as there is a difference between the two. There are nuances throughout each template, but the distinguishing feature is the cover, as illustrated below.



RFI Template Cover



RFP Template Cover

### Your Template Tasks

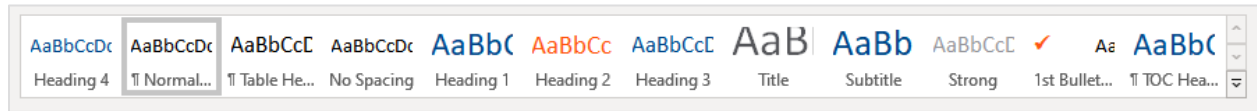
- ✓ Use an Agiloft-approved template found in the Agiloft Proposal Resource Center, here: [PRC > Asset Library > Templates](#).
- ✓ Use the correct template for the relevant opportunity type (RFI vs. RFP).

## Maintaining Consistency Within and Across Agiloft RFXs

### Style Gallery

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Styles are great for managing your document's headers, titles, and text—quickly and easily. Rather than going through the document and adding or changing headers one by one, you can simply apply a style and then make changes to it using the “Styles” ribbon in the Home tab of the Word document (as shown below).



The main function of styles is to allow you to set titles, subheadings, and section headings apart from one another quickly by giving them unique fonts, font characteristics, and sizes. By grouping these characteristics into styles, you can create documents that have a consistent look without having to format each section header manually. Instead, you set the style, and you can control every heading set as that style from a central location.

Not only does using styles help with consistency, but it also helps with efficiency.

A recent example is a corporate change to the Agiloft standard font. In March 2020, Agiloft changed its company font on all collateral (except the website) to [Calibri](#).

All departments were responsible for making this change to their documentation. For the RFX Response Writer's team, this change was accomplished efficiently by going through and updating the styles in the templates and all supporting material. Whew!

### Your Style Gallery Tasks

- ✓ Keep only Agiloft-approved styles in the Style Gallery.
- ✓ Remove all non-Agiloft styles from the Style Gallery if they appear from other sources.
- ✓ Ensure you apply styles to all content.

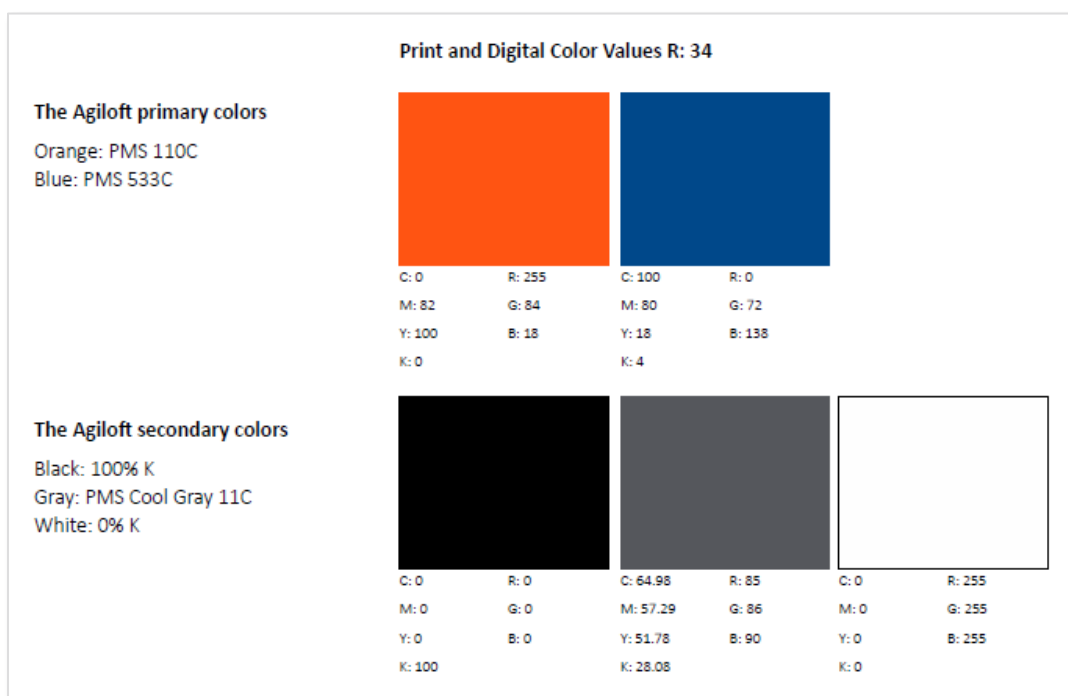
## Maintaining Consistency Within and Across Agiloft RFXs

### Agiloft Colors

Document themes make it easy to coordinate colors, fonts, and graphic formatting effects across Word documents and update them quickly.

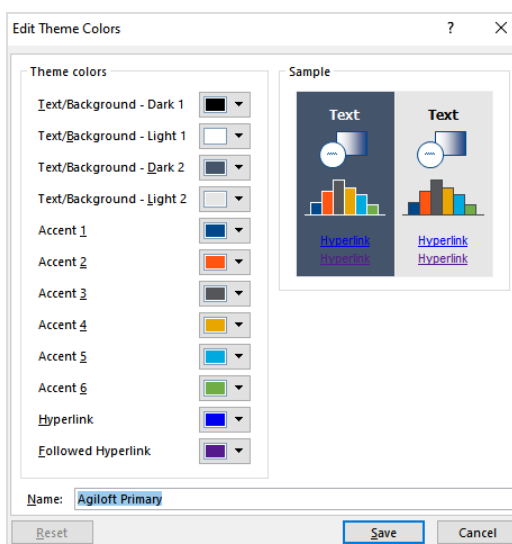
It is possible to lose some formatting in your documents for a variety of reasons. A common formatting glitch appears to be with colors. This inconsistency can be introduced as you collaborate with other team members (internal and external) who are working on different platforms (i.e., Mac vs. PC, tablets, and mobile devices) and have different versions of Word.

It is recommended that you create a Custom Color Theme for Agiloft using the primary and secondary colors shown below. Creating this theme will help alleviate the issue that might arise with varying Agiloft colors.



### Your Color Theme Tasks

- ✓ Create a custom design scheme for Agiloft colors, which is in the “Colors” section of the Design tab in your Word document.
- ✓ Apply this theme whenever you’re working on an Agiloft RFX on which you are collaborating with multiple team members (internal and external).



## Other Related Resources

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- ▶ 6 Steps to Preparing an Agiloft RFX Response
- ▶ Agiloft RFX Writing Style Guide
- ▶ Agiloft Internal RFX Response Process (Training PPT slide deck)